

DR. SARAH FROHNWEILER

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics (Labor, Migration, Education)

EDUCATION

University of Göttingen 2022 - 2025

PhD in *Economics*, summa cum laude, Supervisors: Krisztina Kis-Katos, Jann Lay

Title of dissertation: Improving Labor Market Outcomes – Interventions to Foster Skills Development and Migration in Sub-Saharan Africa

University of Göttingen 2018 - 2020

M.Sc. in *Development Economics*

University of Bayreuth 2014 - 2018

B.A. in *International Economics and Development*

ACADEMIC VISITS

Columbia University 01 - 08/2026

Visiting scholar at the School of International and Public Affairs (SIPA), Suresh Naidu

University of Western Australia 04 - 05/2024

Visiting scholar in the Department of Economics, Christopher Parsons

Tufts University 01 - 03/2024

Visiting scholar at The Fletcher School and the Department of Economics, Jenny Aker

EMPLOYMENT

German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA) Starting 10/2026

Postdoctoral researcher

Maternity leave 10/2025 - 09/2026

Child born 10/10/2025

RWI - Leibniz Institute for Economic Research 08/2020 - 07/2025

Researcher in the research unit *Global Migration*

University of Göttingen 10/2018 - 07/2020

Research assistant at the *Chair of Development Economics*, Prof. Stephan Klasen, PhD

University of Bayreuth 06/2017 - 02/2018

Research assistant at the *Chair of Institutional Economics*, Prof. Dr. Martin Leschke

PUBLICATIONS

Nowak-Lehmann, F., A. Cardozo, P. Elguezabal, S. Frohnweiler, and I. Martínez-Zarzoso (forthcoming). “Asylum Seekers’ Response to Political Risk in Origin Countries: New Evidence for Asylum Seeking in OECD countries.” **Migration Studies**. [[Working paper](#)]

Frohnweiler, S., B. Beber, and C. Ebert (2024). “Information frictions, belief updating and internal migration: Evidence from Ghana and Uganda.” **Journal of Development Economics**, 171, 103311. [[Journal](#)]

Frohnweiler, S., E. Heesemann, M. Perez-Alvarez, M. Santos Silva, and S. Vollmer (2024). “Hospital construction and emergency waiting time: Evidence from Nicaragua.” **Journal of Development Effectiveness**, 17(2), 161–177. [[Journal](#)]

Frohnweiler, S., B. Beber, and C. Ebert (2023). “Delayed effects on migration intentions in an information provision experiment in Ghana.” **Revue d’économie du développement**, 35, 37-44. [[Journal](#)]

WORKING PAPERS

Frohnweiler, S. (2025). “Make me believe. Self-efficacy and human capital investments among young women in Ghana.” [[latest version](#)] [[Development Impact Blog Post](#)]

Frohnweiler, S., B. Beber, T. Lakemann, J. Priebe, and J. Lay (2024). “Effects of skills training on employment and livelihood outcomes: A randomized controlled trial with young women in Ghana.” Ruhr Economic Papers, 1095. [[Working paper](#)]

Beber, B., S. Frohnweiler, T. Lakemann, P. Partey, R. Schnars, and J. Lay (2025). “Skills trainings and Bayesian learning: A multisite randomized controlled trial in Ghana.” Ruhr Economic Papers, 1170. [[Working paper](#)]

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cognitive load, migration, and climate adaptation in Senegal (with B. Beber, L. Detlefsen, C. Ebert, and S. Jahedi)

Development assistance and international migration (with B. Beber)

Teacher self-efficacy and student performance: A randomized controlled trial in Zambia (with S. Schroen, S. Vande Walle, and T. Lubozha)

NON-PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Beber, B., S. Frohnweiler, T. Lakemann, and J. Lay (2024). “Good Jobs through Training: Refining Development Cooperation in Africa.” GIGA Focus Africa, 4, Hamburg: German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA). [[Report](#)]

Ebert, C., D. Flörchinger, S. Frohnweiler, S. Ihring, and M. Rosadio Cayllahua (2021). “Employment and income effects of skills development interventions: An impact evaluation of three employment promotion measures in Eastern Africa within GIZ’s Employment and Skills for Development program.” RWI project report. [[Report](#)]

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026: Brown Bag Tufts University (Medford, USA), SOLE (Denver, USA)

2025: CESifo/ifo Junior Workshop on the Economics of Education (Munich, DEU), European Economic Association Congress (Bordeaux, FRA)

2024: MIT Behavioral Lunch (Cambridge, USA), PhD Workshop Tufts University (Medford, USA), University of Western Australia (Perth, AUS), Curtin University (Perth, AUS), German Development Economics Conference (Hannover, DEU), African Meeting of the Econometric Society (Abidjan, CIV), Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries (Bergen, NOR), Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (Rotterdam, NLD), Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference (Berlin, DEU), Oxford Development Economics Workshop (Oxford, GBR), Berlin School of Economics Workshop (Berlin, DEU)

2023: CSAE Conference (Oxford, GBR), Economics of Migration Junior Seminar (online), Economics of Migration - Junior Workshop (Paris, FRA), German Development Economics Conference (Dresden, DEU), European Association of Labour Economists (Prague, CZE)

2022: Doctoral Workshop on Development Economics of the German Economic Association (Berlin, DEU), IDOS (Bonn, DEU), Berlin Meeting of the Political Economy of Development (Berlin, DEU), NOVAFRICA (Lisbon, PRT)

Services to the Profession

2020 - present: Organizing member of the Development Economics Network Berlin (DENEb) [[Website](#)]

Referee for *Journal of Public Economics* and *Empirical Economics*

TEACHING

Empirical Development Economics, Tutorial, HU Berlin	Summer term 2025
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FIELDWORK & DATA COLLECTION

Principle Investigator for N4G program evaluation in Ghana including three waves	2021-2023
Field Coordinator for ProfArts program evaluation in Ghana including three waves	2020-2023
Field Coordinator for endline data collection of hospital evaluation in Nicaragua	2019

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS

2nd prize for Excellence in Applied Development Research awarded by KfW, EUR 2,500	2026
RWI Research Exchange funding	2024
DAAD Conference Funding	2023
Leibniz PhD Network - Small Event Fund, 8th DENEb PhD Workshop	2023
Scholarship Stiftung der deutschen Wirtschaft (sdw) - Studienförderwerk Klaus Murmann	2018 - 2020

REFERENCES

Krisztina Kis-Katos

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University of Göttingen
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Jann Lay

German Institute for Global and Area Studies
& University of Göttingen
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Cara Ebert

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